

MARINER 4

Space probe

Launched by NASA in November 1964, Mariner 4 was the first space probe to make a successful flyby of Mars. It also sent back the first close-up images of the Red Planet. Scientists were hopeful of seeing signs of life – even vegetation – but all the space probe revealed was a dead, cratered world, much like our Moon.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.89 m (9.5 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 28 November 1964



MISSION DURATION: 3 years, 23 days (deactivated)



SPACE AGENCY: NASA

It took Mariner 4 **seven-and-a-half months** to reach Mars.

A small rocket ensured Mariner 4 stayed on course



Surface of Mars as seen by Mariner 4